

are considering raising prices during this period.

Other challenges for India Inc. centre around concerns about rural demand, and only 35% of respondents expect favourable demand conditions to continue, with the RBI expecting rural demand to pick up. Pant notes that weak monsoon rains in FY24 impacted rural demand. The India Meteorological Department's (IMD) prediction of an above-normal monsoon this year raises expectations that agri GVA will grow at a higher rate. Meanwhile, with inflation likely to trend down, nominal wage growth will also increase. All this will have a positive impact on rural demand," he says.

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QuantEco Research is also of the view that despite the anticipated moderation, the overall growth momentum would stay close to its medium-term trend, with support from the likelihood of a surplus monsoon season later this year. The ongoing General Elections also loom large on the minds of businesses, and 73% of those surveyed believe that they will impact business conditions this quarter.

The coming months could, however, help revive sentiments if the Israel-Iran crisis gets resolved. The prediction of an above-normal monsoon could lift rural demand. The formation of a new government by June and work on the Union Budget could also help India Inc. feel more confident about prospects. **BT**

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CORPORATE

Robust Start

Early-bird results for the January-March 2024 quarter indicate a double-digit growth in consolidated profits for India Inc.

BY RAHUL OBEROI

► **THE FOURTH QUARTER** of FY24 has brought happy tidings for India Inc. A calculation of the results declared till May 6 shows that consolidated net profit rose 30% year-on-year (YoY) in Q4FY24, against a 4% rise in the year-ago period. The top line witnessed a rise of 14% YoY to ₹8.8 lakh crore.

A total of 28 companies in the Nifty 50 index had reported their results in Q4FY24 till May 6. While some of them showed resilience and growth, others grappled with challenges stem-

ming from economic uncertainties and shifting consumer behaviour.

Let us take a closer look at the sectors. The IT sector reported a mixed set of results. While TCS and Infosys posted 9.14% and 30% YoY growth, respectively, in consolidated net profit, to ₹12,434 crore and ₹7,969 crore, for HCLTech, the number was almost flat at 0.08% YoY to ₹3,986 crore. The net profit of Tech Mahindra, LTIMindtree, and Wipro witnessed a decline of 41%, 1.23%